CPR IN SCHOOLS

A National Need for a Viksit Bharat by 2047

Dr. V.K. Jain, often called the 'CPR Doctor of India', is a senior physician and public health advocate who has dedicated his life to a transformative mission: ensuring that every Indian citizen, especially students, is equipped with life-saving CPR (Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation) skills by 2047. With over 45 years of medical experience and having trained more than 2 lakh individuals across India, Dr. Jain envisions a nation where CPR is as fundamental as fire safety and as accessible as school education. In this exclusive interview, he speaks about the gaps in India's emergency response system, the role of CPR in saving lives, and the path to a truly Viksit Bharat.



Dr. V.K. Jain
MBBS MD Physician,
Founder CPR India Movement

Dr. Jain, you're often referred to as the 'CPR Doctor of India.' Can you tell us what led you to take up this mission so passionately?

The title was never something I sought—it came organically through my work. Over the years, I saw far too many lives lost due to delays in basic response. Most of these people could have been saved if only someone nearby had known how to administer CPR. That realisation changed my life. I decided that I wouldn't just treat patients—I would empower citizens to become life-savers.

For those unfamiliar, what exactly is CPR—and why is it such a critical life-saving skill, especially in India?

CPR is a simple hands-on emergency procedure performed on someone who has collapsed due to cardiac arrest. Chest compressions are given at a depth of 5–6 cm and a rate of 100–120 per minute to pump blood from the heart to the brain and other vital organs, ensuring oxygen supply.

You've often spoken about a major policy and awareness gap in India's emergency response system. What does that gap look like today?

India's bystander CPR rate is dangerously low—between 1.3% to 9.8%. Ambulance response times are inconsistent, and public awareness is poor. What makes this worse is that CPR training is not part of our national education system. We're losing lives every day, not due to lack of medical facilities—but due to inaction in the golden minutes.

We lose over 7 lakh lives every year to sudden cardiac arrest. In your view, how can this be reduced at scale?

The first and most effective step is to integrate CPR training in secondary schools across all boards. A single 45-minute session can create lifelong awareness. Imagine the scale if every child in India graduates school already CPR-trained—we would create a new generation of first responders.

Why do you believe schools are the ideal starting point for your vision of Viksit Bharat 2047?

Schools are the heart of any societal change. Children learn fast, and they carry those values home. If we start now, by 2047, India will have at least one CPR-trained person in every household. That alone can reduce cardiac-related fatalities dramatically.

What role should the government, schools, and the general public play to make CPR a national movement?

The Ministry of Education and the Ministry of Health must work together to mandate CPR training in the curriculum. Schools must prioritise safety, just as they do for fire drills. And citizens must realise that knowing CPR is not optional—it's a moral responsibility.

You've had international exposure too. How are other countries handling this?

Countries like Japan, the US, and Australia have made CPR training and AED availability mandatory in schools and public places. Their survival rates from cardiac arrest are double or triple compared to India. These policies work—we just need to adapt them.

You've trained over 2 lakh people already. Could you share a story that shows the power of CPR?

Just a day after attending our CPR session at the Rajasthan High Court, Mr. Nagar, a dedicated advocate, saved the life of a passerby. His quick action and presence of mind turned knowledge into a lifesaving moment — a true example of how timely training can make a difference.

What is your vision for 2047, and how do CPR and AEDs fit into India's future?

By 2047, I envision an India where CPR is part of every school's curriculum, and AEDs—Automated External Defibrillators—are installed in every institution just like fire extinguishers. CPR is the first step, and AED is the next. With both in place, we can create a culture where no heart stops without a fight.